

Tester Guide — Always Loading the Latest Version

Read this first. This guide is **only for us, the people testing the course right now**. It is **not** something students will ever have to do.

We need it because the lessons are **still being updated**: every time a notebook is fixed and pushed, the live site changes. JupyterLite, however, **saves a personal copy of each notebook inside your browser** the first time you open it — and it will keep showing you *that* copy, not the updated one online. So while we iterate, we have to make sure we are looking at the latest version, not a stale local copy.

For students this never matters: they open it once and just work. The caching behaviour is actually a *feature* for them (their work is saved automatically in the browser).

Course links

Course home: <https://andreatagliabue.github.io/python-unige/>

Direct notebook links (`?path=` opens that notebook straight away):

Lesson	Link
1 — Introduction	https://andreatagliabue.github.io/python-unige/notebooks/index.html?path=01_introduction.ipynb
2 — Python basics	https://andreatagliabue.github.io/python-unige/notebooks/index.html?path=02_python_basics.ipynb
3 — Data I/O and tables	https://andreatagliabue.github.io/python-unige/notebooks/index.html?path=03_data_io_and_tables.ipynb
4 — Plotting and analysis	https://andreatagliabue.github.io/python-unige/notebooks/index.html?path=04_plotting_and_analysis.ipynb
5 — Fitting, statistics, automation	https://andreatagliabue.github.io/python-unige/notebooks/index.html?path=05_fitting_stats_automation.ipynb

Method 1 — Private / Incognito window (recommended, simplest)

A private window starts with **empty storage**, so there is no old notebook copy and no stale cache. This is the easiest way to guarantee a clean test.

Browser	Open a private window
Chrome	Ctrl + Shift + N (Windows/Linux) · Cmd + Shift + N (Mac)
Edge	Ctrl + Shift + N — "InPrivate"
Firefox	Ctrl + Shift + P (Windows/Linux) · Cmd + Shift + P (Mac)
Safari	Cmd + Shift + N

Important caveat: a private session lives until you close **all** private windows. Opening a second incognito tab reuses the same storage. So between two tests:

1. **Close every private/incognito window** (not just the tab).
2. Open a brand-new private window.
3. Paste the link and test.

That guarantees a clean drive each time.

Method 2 — Clear the site data (when you tested in a normal window)

If you have already opened the course in a normal window and need to wipe the saved copy, clear the data **for the course origin** (`andreatagliabue.github.io`). This removes the JupyterLite drive, the cache, and the service worker in one go.

Chrome / Edge (fastest, via DevTools)

1. Open the course site.
2. Press `F12` to open DevTools.
3. Go to the **Application** tab → left sidebar **Storage**.
4. Click **Clear site data** (this clears IndexedDB, cache storage, *and* unregisters the service worker — exactly what we need).
5. Close DevTools and reload (`Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + R`).

Alternative without DevTools: click the **padlock / "tune" icon** left of the address bar → **Site settings** (or "Cookies and site data") → **Delete data**.

Firefox

1. Click the **padlock icon** left of the address bar.
2. **Clear cookies and site data...** → confirm. (Or: *Settings* → *Privacy & Security* → *Cookies and Site Data* → *Manage Data* → search `andreatagliabue.github.io` → *Remove Selected*.)
3. Reload (`Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + R`).

Safari

1. **Safari** → **Settings** → **Privacy** → **Manage Website Data...**
2. Search `andreatagliabue.github.io` → **Remove** → **Done**. (To also flush caches: enable the *Develop menu in Settings* → *Advanced*, then **Develop** → **Empty Caches**.)
3. Reload.

Method 3 — A separate browser / profile

If you do not want to disturb your main browser, just test in a **different browser** (or a fresh browser profile) that you never use for the course. First open there = clean state.

Quick checklist for every test

- ☐ Closed **all** previous incognito/private windows.
 - ☐ Opened a **fresh** incognito window.
 - ☐ Pasted the direct lesson link.
 - ☐ (If anything looks stale) cleared site data — Method 2 — and reloaded.
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Appendix — Why a normal refresh is not enough

When you open a notebook in JupyterLite, two separate things get stored in your browser:

1. **The app and its files** — cached by the browser (HTTP cache + a *service worker*).
2. **Your working copy of the notebook** — copied into a private in-browser storage area (IndexedDB, the JupyterLite "drive").

A normal reload — even a *hard* reload (`Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + R`) — only refreshes part of (1). It does **not** clear (2). So if you have already opened, say, `04_plotting_and_analysis.ipynb` , JupyterLite keeps serving you the copy saved in your browser, and you will **not** see the new version even after we push a fix.

Bottom line: to be certain you are on the latest version, you must either use a **fresh private/incognito window** (Method 1) or **clear the site data** (Method 2).